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Admissions Committee
International Master in Data Analytics
University of Hildesheim

Motivation Letter: International Master in Data Analytics

Dear Members of the Admissions Committee,

I am writing to apply for the International Master in Data Analytics at the University of Hildesheim. I graduated in July 2025 with a B.Sc. in Computer Science from Pharos University in Alexandria, Excellent with Honors (CGPA 3.76 out of 4.00), and over the past year I have become sure that data analytics and machine learning are what I want to build my career on.

My interest really started in my third year, in the Machine Learning course. Until then most of my courses were about writing programs that follow rules I define myself. Seeing a model learn those rules from data instead felt completely different, and I finished the course with 94, one of my best grades. After that I paid more attention to the mathematics behind it. I did well in Numerical Computations (97), Linear Algebra (91) and Probability and Statistics (87), and courses like Data Science Methodology and Intelligent Systems showed me how much work goes into a dataset before any model is trained.

For my graduation project, Mentoro, our team of six built a mentoring platform that recommends courses, tasks and mentors to learners based on their goals and progress. I designed the full interface in Figma and built a large part of the web frontend. Working with my teammates on how the recommendations should behave, I noticed that the hard questions were never about the interface. They were about data: what we actually know about a learner, how to measure progress, and how to tell whether a recommendation is good. I could not answer those questions properly with what I knew, and that is one of the main reasons I am applying. On my own I also worked on image generation with diffusion models on CIFAR-10, which taught me how much patience training and debugging a model really takes.

After graduating, I worked for a year as a Teaching Assistant at my faculty, teaching labs in Programming 1, System Programming, Compiler Design and Human-Computer Interaction. Explaining the same idea to a full lab of students in different ways made my own understanding much more solid, and it showed me that I enjoy careful, structured work. Since August 2026 I also work as a freelance full stack developer for a small marketing agency, where part of my work is testing and comparing image and video generation models for the team. Using these models every day made me want to understand how they work from the inside, not only how to call them.

The International Master in Data Analytics fits this goal very well. I like that the program combines a strong base in machine learning and statistics with practical work on real data, and that it is closely connected to the university's machine learning research. Studying in English in an international group is also important to me, since my whole bachelor's degree was taught and assessed in English. Germany's mix of research and industry is exactly the environment where I want to grow.

After the master's, I would like to work as a data scientist or machine learning engineer, ideally on recommendation and personalisation problems, especially in education, where I have already seen how much good guidance changes a learner's path. If I find the right research topic during my studies, I would also seriously consider a PhD.

I know the program is demanding, and I am ready for that. Thank you for considering my application. I would be very happy to provide any further information.

Sincerely,

Mayar Mohamed Issa